XAVIER LAI

Data Platform Engineer

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SUMMARY

Data Engineer with 6+ years of experience building scalable data platforms from the ground up. Specialized in cloud architecture on GCP, data modeling and platform engineering. Experienced technical lead with a strong focus on automation, cost optimization and mentorship.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Platform Engineer | Doctolib | Jan 2026 - Present

- Build reusable self-service components in the Platform Team, enabling teams to ingest and export data in a Data Mesh handling highly sensitive health data at scale
- Joined during the GCP migration and Data Mesh rollout (data products, domains, ownership)
- Contribute to a cloud-native stack: Kubernetes, Crossplane, custom controllers
- Run platform reliability: Datadog observability and alerting, on-call rotation, incident response
- Practice spec-driven development with AI: Claude skills, agents, subagents, routines, loops and context engineering applied to platform work

Tech Lead Data | Cabaia | Jan 2024 - Jan 2026 | 2 years

- Built a resilient data platform on GCP using Airbyte, dbt, Dagster and BigQuery, adopted as the source of truth by all departments
- Modeled fewer than 10 reusable fact tables covering 80% of stakeholder reporting needs
- Delivered trusted Power BI dashboards on a unified semantic model for business self-service
- Ensured 12+ months of uninterrupted data reliability; hired and mentored a data team

Data Engineer | C-Ways | Jan 2021 - Jan 2024 | 3 years

- Architected a Data Platform integrated with a CDP for B&B Hotels, enabling real-time marketing automation
- Led a team to build an NLP-based risk scoring tool for French Customs (DGDDI), cutting manual review time from 1 day to 1 hour via social media webscraping
- Developed CRM automation tools that enabled €20K of billable insight in under 2 days

Adjunct Professor | Rennes 2 University | 2022 - Present | 30h/year

- Teach advanced Python for data engineering to Master's students and mentor end-to-end projects

EDUCATION

Master in Applied Mathematics, Data Science | Rennes 2 University | 2020

SKILLS

Cloud & Platform: GCP (Certified), Kubernetes, Crossplane, Terraform, Docker, CI/CD
Data Engineering: Python, SQL, dbt, Dagster, Airbyte, Spark, BigQuery, batch & streaming
Observability: Datadog, monitoring, alerting, on-call
AI Engineering: Spec-driven development, harness, context, evaluation, judgement
Analytics: Power BI (Premium per User), applied machine learning